STAKEHOLDER BRIEFING · APRIL 2026

PolyWiz Paid Ads

A proposal to turn newsletter signups into an autopilot system

$250–$500 / brand / month

Meta MVP

The Intersect Pilot

THE OPPORTUNITY

Three things just lined up

1. ZERNIO SHIPPED ADS

One API for 6 platforms

Meta, LinkedIn, Google, TikTok, Pinterest, X — all reachable through the same key we already use for organic posts.

2. WE OWN THE MOAT

Creative volume

Meta's 2026 algorithm rewards creative variety over targeting tweaks. PolyWiz already produces dozens of variants per campaign — exactly what Meta wants.

3. PROVEN AT SCALE

$0.80 CPA history

Juergen ran $70K/year Meta budgets that hit $0.80–0.90 per signup manually. Goal: rebuild that result on autopilot.

Translation for the brands: more newsletter subscribers, more Instagram followers, lower cost per acquisition, less hand-holding.

WHAT THIS ACTUALLY IS

In plain English

1. **Brand picks a piece of content**
   A blog post, exhibition page, or newsletter issue. Same input PolyWiz already takes for organic.

2. **PolyWiz generates 8–15 ad variations**
   Different images, different headlines, different angles — built from the brand's existing visuals and voice.

3. **You approve. Meta runs them.**
   A single click pushes the variants to Facebook + Instagram. Meta's algorithm picks the winners and spends the budget.

4. **PolyWiz tracks CPA, kills losers, scales winners**
   Daily polling pulls spend + signup data. Bottom 20% of variants get killed weekly. New variants generated to refill.

WHAT WE ALREADY HAVE VS. WHAT'S NEW

The build is mostly extension, not invention

ALREADY IN POLYWIZ · ~80%

- ✓ Brand voice + tone slider
- ✓ Multi-platform copy generation (Claude)
- ✓ Image catalog from scraped URLs
- ✓ Auto-crop to platform aspect ratios
- ✓ Carousel + cover-slide rendering
- ✓ Vercel Blob image hosting
- ✓ Per-brand API key resolution
- ✓ Zernio scheduling integration

NEW CAPABILITIES · ~20%

- + Ad-specific copy prompt (10-intent angle slots)
- + Image variant generator (FLUX, Ideogram)
- + Zernio Ads API client
- + Polling cron (no webhooks available)
- + Performance dashboard
- + Variant rotation logic
- + Instant Form submissions handling
- + Conversion event mapping

The creative engine is the moat. The new pieces wire it into Meta's ad system.

PLATFORM-BY-PLATFORM FIT

What we should actually run, and what we shouldn't

Meta (FB + IG)	PHASE 1 / MVP	Best fit. Lowest learning floor, mature lead gen.
LinkedIn Lead Gen	PHASE 2	Killer for arts professionals. Zernio gap → direct API.
Pinterest	PHASE 2	Visual-discovery fit. Zernio shipped. CPC 30–50% cheaper than Meta.
Google Search	PHASE 1.5	Optional. Cheap to add, no video required.
TikTok	PHASE 3	$20/day floor — needs $1.5K+/mo to scale.
YouTube Shorts	PHASE 3	Needs video pipeline first.
Google PMax	SKIP	Sub-$3K/mo learning floor.
X (Twitter)	SKIP	Brand safety + targeting degraded.

WHAT CPA WE SHOULD EXPECT

Realistic targets — not the hype

JUERGEN'S 2024 BENCHMARK

$0.80

Achieved manually, hot industries, mature pixel signal.

RETARGETING

$0.80–1.50

Site visitors + IG engagers. Achievable in 30–60 days.

COLD PROSPECTING (90-DAY)

$1.50–3.00

Honest target while algorithm learns at this budget.

2026 META INDUSTRY MEDIAN

$27.66

What's typical. We aim to beat this by 10–30×.

At $250/mo and a $2 CPA, expect ~125 new newsletter subscribers per brand per month. The Intersect, NRA, and Artsville together: ~375 net-new subscribers/month for $750 + $50 Zernio.

WHAT'S BLOCKING US TODAY

Three things must be in place before we can launch

1
ZERNIO ADD-ON

$50/mo upgrade. Without it, every API call returns "Ads add-on required."

2
PIXELS ON SITES

Artsville is missing Meta Pixel. Intersect is missing CAPI. Without them iOS users are invisible.

3
CURATED PLATFORM

The Intersect runs on Curated (sunset 2024). Constrains tracking. Migration plan needed.

All three are solvable in days, not weeks — but they must precede ad launch.

PIXEL STATUS — VERIFIED 2026-04-24

Where each brand stands today

Not Real Art	WordPress	Pixel ✓	CAPI ✓	GTM ✗	Strong. Drop dead UA tag, add GA4.
Artsville USA	Ghost 6.33	Pixel ✗	CAPI ✗	GA4 ✓	Cannot run paid Meta ads today.
The Intersect	Curated	Pixel ✓	CAPI ✗	GTM ✗	Add CAPI via Stape.io GTM.

Without server-side CAPI, browser tracking captures only 70–80% of conversions. With CAPI: 90–95%. Cost-per-result drops 17.8% when CAPI is on.

PHASE PLAN

Aggressive timeline — AI-paired-dev hours, not engineering weeks

- **Phase 0 — Prerequisites** ~1 day
  Buy Zernio Ads add-on. Connect Meta ad accounts via OAuth. Install Meta Pixel + CAPI on Artsville. Add CAPI on Intersect via Stape.io.

- **Phase 1 — Meta MVP, Intersect pilot** ~1–2 weeks
  Airtable schema, Zernio Ads client, ad creative pipeline, polling cron, dashboard. Pilot at $250/mo for 30 days. Honest CPA target: $1.50–3.00.

- **Phase 2 — LinkedIn Lead Gen Forms** ~1 week
  Direct LinkedIn Marketing API (Zernio doesn't ship Lead Gen Forms yet). Job-title targeting: Curator, Gallery Director, Editor. Lead delivery to brand's email provider.

- **Phase 3 — Video pipeline + TikTok + YouTube** ~1.5 weeks
  Slideshow video generator (Invideo + Runway). TikTok Photo Mode carousel ads. YouTube Shorts. Migrate Intersect off Curated to Ghost or Beehiiv.

RISKS

What could go wrong, and how we'll catch it

- AI-generated copy starts to sound like AI
- Cold prospecting at $250/mo never escapes Meta's learning phase
- Meta auto-rewrites our brand copy via Advantage+ Creative
- Zernio Ads API response shapes differ from documentation at runtime
- iOS users are unmeasurable until pixels are fully installed

DECISIONS WE NEED FROM YOU

Eight open questions before we start

1. Are you ready to commit to the $50/mo Zernio Ads add-on upgrade? (Confirmed yes — pending exact tier verification with Zernio support.)
2. Who installs the missing pixels — your web person, or PolyWiz dev directly?
3. When does The Intersect migrate off Curated? Target platform — Ghost or Beehiiv?
4. Newsletter provider per brand — confirm what's wired up (Mailchimp, Beehiiv, Ghost native, ConvertKit, Curated)?
5. Brand voice control: do art brands tolerate Meta auto-rewriting copy, or default to disabled?
6. Lookalike seeds — exportable engagement data ("opened ≥3 emails in 30 days") or start with raw lists?
7. Add a qualifying question on Instant Form? (Filters bots/freebie-hunters, adds friction.)
8. Budget escalation rule: if CPA < $3 after 30 days, auto-double to $500/mo? Or wait for human review?

WHAT WE'RE ASKING FOR

A green light to start Phase 0

SPEND THIS WEEK

$50

Zernio Ads add-on — unlocks the API for live probing.

SPEND THIS MONTH

$300

$250 Intersect pilot + $50 Zernio. 30-day burn-in, then evaluate.

SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

CPA < $3

~85+ new Intersect subscribers in month 1. Then scale to NRA + Artsville.

If the pilot hits its CPA target, the same engine extends to Not Real Art and Artsville USA with no additional build cost — just the per-brand ad budget.

The math at $250/mo × 3 brands × $2 CPA = ~375 new subscribers per month for $750.

Let's start Phase 0

Questions? Open the GitHub epic — issue #181

Sources & References

All research lives in ideas/007-polywiz-paid-ads-engine/research/ — Phase 0–3 sub-issues, plus sources.md with every URL, verbatim quote, retrieval date, and defensibility note.

Andromeda rewards creative volume + diversity — Meta Engineering, Dec 2024

17.8% lower cost-per-result with CAPI — Meta announcement, Apr 2026

Detailed interest targeting deprecated Jan 2026 — Meta Help Center via Brandwatch

Zernio Ads API for 6 platforms (Apr 17 2026) — zernio.com launch post

$27.66 Meta lead-gen median CPL (2026) — AdAmigo Q1 2026 benchmarks

Pinterest CPC $0.50–$1.50 vs Meta $1.06–$1.72 — WebFX 2026 · Tailwind 2025

TikTok $20/day floor + 50 conv/week to exit learning — TikTok Ads Manager docs

Pinterest 619M MAU, +12% YoY (Q4 2025) — Pinterest Q4 2025 earnings

Plus internal/first-party data (Zernio 403 probe, brand pixel status, $0.80–$0.90 historical CPA on $70K/yr Meta budgets) — all logged in `research/sources.md`.